The Heart of Noble Avalokiteśvara, known in Tibetan as Phakpa Chenrezik kyi Nyin

Toh 911 · Derge Kangyur

The Heart of Noble Avalokiteśvara, known in Tibetan as Phakpa Chenrezik kyi Nyingpo and likely corresponding to a Sanskrit title along the lines of Ārya Avalokiteśvara Hṛdaya, is a very brief devotional text centered on a single knowledge mantra. It opens with homage to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, and to the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the great being. It then presents a mantra invoking him as the one who holds a lotus in his hand. The text promises that whoever recites this mantra will remember their births through a hundred thousand lifetimes and, upon dying, will be reborn in the pure realm of Sukhāvatī. It is Toh 911 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the short dhāraṇī and mantra texts gathered in the collection's tantra and dhāraṇī material.

Homage to the Buddha. Homage to the Dharma. Homage to the Saṅgha. Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva, the great being.

Having paid homage to them, I shall recite this knowledge mantra. May this knowledge mantra be accomplished for me.

tadyathā ha ha hasane nipasane tapa tapane jvala jvalane cala calane pūrbayoga smara padmahastāya svāhā

Whoever recites this knowledge mantra will remember their births through a hundred thousand lifetimes, and when they die and pass from this life, they will be born in the world of Sukhāvatī.

The Heart of Noble Avalokiteśvara is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "Knowledge mantra" translates rig pa (Skt. vidyā), a spell or incantation. The final line of the dhāraṇī addresses Avalokiteśvara as Padmahasta, "Lotus in Hand."

Colophon

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Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.